

Talk 1: Growing Bodies & Growing Curiosity

Ages 6–8

Introduction

Hi, and welcome to Bright Talks.

As parents, many of us want our children to grow up feeling confident, safe, and comfortable in their own bodies. But for many families, conversations about bodies and growing up can feel awkward because no one modeled those conversations for us growing up.

The good news is that these discussions don't have to be complicated.

As children move into the ages of six, seven, and eight, something begins to change. They're noticing more. They're asking more questions. They may start comparing their bodies with friends or siblings, becoming more aware of privacy, or wondering why boys and girls are different.

That growing curiosity isn't something we need to shut down.

It's an invitation to stay connected.

Growing Bodies, Growing Awareness

Children develop at different rates, and during these years, they're becoming increasingly aware that bodies don't all look the same.

They may notice differences in height, weight, hair, skin, or body shape. They may become more modest or suddenly want privacy when getting dressed.

These are normal parts of growing up.

When your child makes an observation or asks a question, try to respond calmly and matter-of-factly.

You might say:

"Everyone's body grows a little differently, and that's okay."

Or:

"Your body will keep changing as you get older. If you ever have questions about those changes, you can always ask me."

Simple responses like these communicate something powerful:

There is nothing embarrassing about growing up.

Curiosity Is Normal

At this age, questions may also become more specific.

Your child might ask why bodies are different, where babies come from, or something they heard from a friend at school.

Sometimes those questions catch us completely off guard.

Our instinct might be to change the subject or wonder, *"Why are they asking me this already?"*

But curiosity is a normal part of childhood development. Children are constantly trying to understand how the world works including their own bodies.

You don't have to give them every detail.

Listen to the question they're actually asking, give a simple and truthful answer, and then pause.

Often, that's enough.

And when you don't know what to say, it's okay to respond:

"That's a good question. Let me think about the best way to answer it, and we'll talk about it together."

You're showing your child that questions are welcome, even when the answers take a little time.

Preparing for Changes Ahead

As your child's curiosity grows, one of the best things you can do is stay curious too.

When they ask a question, you don't always have to rush to give an answer. Sometimes you can simply ask:

"What made you think about that?"

or,

"What have you heard about that already?"

Those small questions can tell you a lot about what your child is thinking, what they may be hearing from others, and what they're actually ready to understand.

Most importantly, they keep the conversation open.

When we respond to curiosity with curiosity—not embarrassment or alarm—we show our children that questions are welcome here. And that helps establish something we want them to carry into every stage of growing up:

"I can always talk to my parent about this."

For some children, the earliest signs of puberty can begin sooner than parents expect, while for others those changes will come several years later.

That's why these years are a wonderful time to begin preparing—not because something needs to happen right now, but because children feel more confident when changes don't come as a complete surprise.

A Christian Perspective

As Christians, we believe our bodies were intentionally created by God and are worthy of care and respect.

And while every person develops differently, those differences don't determine their value.

Science helps us understand how bodies grow and develop.

Our faith reminds us that through every stage of that development, our worth remains the same.

When we speak about growing bodies without embarrassment or shame, we help our children see their bodies as something to understand, care for, and be grateful for.

Key Takeaway

Your child's growing curiosity isn't a problem to solve.

It's an opportunity to strengthen your relationship.

Every question gives you another chance to say:

"You can talk to me."

Every honest answer builds trust.

And every calm conversation today makes the bigger conversations tomorrow a little easier.

Wrapping Up

As we finish today's lesson, remember that you don't need to prepare your child for every change all at once.

You're simply laying the foundation.

Keep listening.

Keep answering honestly.

And keep reminding your child that growing up is nothing to be ashamed of and that you'll be there to walk through it with them.

As their world continues to expand, however, you won't be the only voice they hear.

Friends, classmates, older children, media, and everyday conversations may introduce ideas or words your child doesn't understand.

In our next talk, we'll explore *When Kids Hear Things From Friends* and how to respond when your child comes home and asks a question you weren't expecting.

We'll help you turn those surprising moments into opportunities for connection rather than panic.

We'll see you in the next lesson.